Section 1: Scope and Annual Leave

This policy applies to all full-time employees of Northwind Tech Pvt. Ltd. who have completed their probation period of three months. Interns and contract staff follow the separate Contractor Handbook. The policy is effective from 1 January 2026 and is reviewed every year by the Human Resources team.

Every full-time employee is entitled to 18 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Leave is credited monthly at the rate of 1.5 days per month. Annual leave must be applied for through the HR portal at least 7 days in advance, and requests longer than 5 consecutive working days need approval from both the reporting manager and the department head.

Unused annual leave can be carried forward to the next year up to a maximum of 10 days. Any balance above 10 days lapses on 31 December. At the time of resignation, unused annual leave up to 30 days is paid out (encashed) at the employee's basic salary rate.

Section 2: Sick Leave and Casual Leave

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per year. Sick leave cannot be carried forward and cannot be encashed. For sick leave of more than 2 consecutive days, the employee must upload a medical certificate from a registered doctor to the HR portal within 3 days of returning to work. Sick leave may also be used to care for an ill spouse, child or parent.

In addition, employees receive 6 days of casual leave per year for personal matters such as family events or urgent errands. Casual leave can be taken for at most 2 days at a time and should be informed to the manager at least one day in advance, except in emergencies.

If an employee has used all their paid leave, further absence is recorded as leave without pay (LWP). More than 3 days of unapproved absence in a row may lead to disciplinary action under the Code of Conduct.

Section 3: Parental Leave and Work From Home

Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for their first two children, in line with the Maternity Benefit Act. Up to 8 weeks of this may be taken before the expected delivery date. Male employees and partners are entitled to 10 working days of paid paternity leave, which must be used within 3 months of the child's birth or adoption.

Employees adopting a child below the age of 3 months receive 12 weeks of paid adoption leave.

Work from home (WFH): after completing probation, employees may work from home up to 2 days per week, with their manager's approval. WFH days cannot be carried over to the next week. Employees working from home must be reachable on the company chat tool between 10:00 AM and 6:00 PM.

For questions about this policy, contact the HR helpdesk at hr-help@northwind.example or extension 2040.